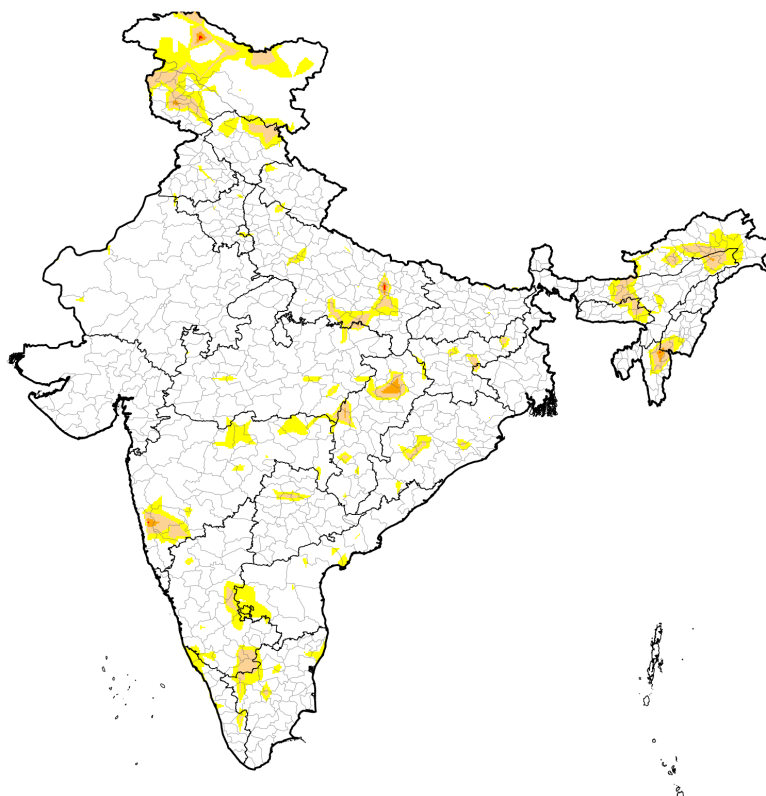




Combined Drought Index (CDI) for the week ending May 20, 2026.

Summary

The national drought situation this week shows a large area remaining in the Normal category, with 84.7% of India experiencing normal conditions. The total area affected by drought, specifically the D0+ class, was 15.3% this week. This figure has shown a contraction compared to previous periods, as the drought area decreased by 0.9 percentage points week-on-week, moving from 16.2% in the last week and 17.2% approximately one month ago. The regions most affected by drought include NCT of Delhi with 52.2% of its area in drought, followed by Manipur at 42.3%, Mizoram at 40.8%, Arunachal Pradesh at 40.3%, Jammu & Kashmir at 38.9%, and Meghalaya at 34.1%. Conversely, West Bengal reported 0.0% in drought, while Rajasthan, Gujarat, and Telangana reported 1.0%, 2.1%, and 3.4% in drought, respectively.

Regional Outlook

North Moderate, scattered drought. About 28% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Northwest Largely normal conditions. About 4% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Northeast Moderate, scattered drought. About 27% of the area is in drought (D0–D4). Pockets of severe-or-worse conditions are present.

East Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 7% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Central Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 15% of the area is in drought (D0–D4). Pockets of severe-or-worse conditions are present.

West Moderate, scattered drought. About 22% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

South Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 16% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).